

Saheli First Responder

Project Report: November - January (18)

Fellow Name: Samina Batool & Gulshan Fatima

Village / Area: Saltoro, Ghanche GB Pakistan

Saheli Circle(s) Covered:6

Leadership Team Members Involved:10 girls 8 boys

Overview: Community Climate Context:

Our community is located in the Saltoro–Siachen belt of Ghanche District, Gilgit-Baltistan, a remote high-altitude mountainous region of northern Pakistan. The area faces severe climate challenges due to its geographic isolation, harsh weather conditions, and weak infrastructure, particularly unpaved roads that are highly vulnerable to landslides and flooding.

The community experiences frequent landslides, recurring floods and riverbank erosion, accelerated glacier melt, and avalanches near glacier zones. These risks intensify between June and August, when seasonal rainfall and glacier melt combine, making mobility difficult and disrupting daily life. Rising temperatures, especially during summer months, have further increased environmental instability and contributed to faster glacier melt.

Recent climate events have caused significant damage across the Union Council, which comprises 12 villages, with Goma, Gamba, and Mallon being the most affected. In the most recent season, intensified river erosion brought rivers dangerously close to settlements and washed away large areas of agricultural land. Roadside landslides repeatedly blocked access routes, isolating villages and limiting access to health, education, and markets. These events have affected hundreds of households, particularly farming families dependent on agriculture and livestock, through loss of land, reduced crop production, and negative impacts on livestock health.

Overall, the community is situated in a high climate-vulnerability context, where climate-induced hazards increasingly threaten livelihoods, food security, mobility,

and well-being, with women, children, and farming households being the most affected.

2. Your work as an organizer (Saheli Leader: First Responder)

Between November and January, the main focus of the work was organizing and raising awareness in the community about climate change and our ongoing initiatives. A key part of this effort was team-building and consciousness-raising, as many community members perceive climate-related events as “acts of God.”

To address specific vulnerabilities, Menstrual Hygiene Management (MHM) sessions were conducted across the community, targeting women and adolescent girls to reduce the challenges they face during disasters. Go-bag preparedness sessions were held with the Salto Saheli network, women’s groups, and girls in various Saheli circles to improve readiness for emergencies.

Community engagement also involved meetings with school administrators and principals of both public and government schools to strengthen collaboration. In addition, a four-day capacity-building training on climate education was conducted at Siachen Public School, Salto, enhancing local knowledge and teaching skills. Saheli circle girls were also trained to collect data for a community knowledge guidebook, contributing to a structured understanding of local climate risks and resources.

Overall, the work emphasized community organization, awareness-raising, capacity-building, and empowerment, particularly for women and girls, to improve resilience and preparedness for climate-related hazards.

2. Activities Conducted

Fill in the table for all major activities.

Date	Activity Type	Location	Participants (Girls/Women/Men)	Key Topics (Climate / MHM / WASH / Preparedness / CBDRMC)
22 Nov	Saheli circle reopening	Saheli circle Goma	18 participants with two mentors	Breathing exercises, session on exam preparation, tech access data collection,
23 Nov	School visit and meeting	Middle school Goma	Teachers	Exam preparation, SMC role in school, education challenges, SMC training discussions
25 Nov	School meeting	Siachen public school	Principal & teachers	Students' exam preparation, climate education and training, Saheli first responder model, myths, importance of ECD training,
26 Nov	School visit, student interaction, Meeting with Saheli mentors	High school Saith	Teacher & Students	Aware teacher about Saheli first responder model, exam preparation tips for students and discussing on SMC roles and about examination.

28 Nov	LT meeting	Sakina House	Salto Saheli network	Briefed on the model, discussion on MHM sessions and leader forming, boys' inclusion in team, climate work planning
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Date	Location	Participants	Activity / Session	Key Highlights / Outcomes
29 Nov 2025	Haji Ali House, Goma	17 boys youth + 5 SSN members	Youth consultation meeting	- Discussed upcoming Climate First Responders & Education Program - Inclusion of men and boys in SSN programs - Formed a team of 10 boys for climate education & disaster management - Creation of team for climate leadership - Plans to create community knowledge-based content books - Explored collaboration with Saloro Student Welfare Society
29 Nov 2025	Haji Ali House, Goma	Same	Discussion points	- Overview of KOH E ZAN & SSN work for past 5 months - Explained Saheli Circle purpose - Emphasized importance of mixed-gender teams for health, hygiene, and disaster preparedness - Discussed alternate use of baby diapers ("Bil") and ice topa formation for water-scarce lands

Date	Location	Participants	Activity / Session	Key Highlights / Outcomes
29 Nov 2025	Haji Ali House, Goma	Same	Reflection on patriarchy & feminism	- Boys raised cultural perspective; discussion paused as it was off-agenda - Discussion on feminism and clarified feminism as equality, not superiority, emphasizing teamwork with men

2–6
Dec
2025

Siachen Public School, Saltoro
Principal + 12 teachers

Climate Educator
Training

- A five-day interactive Climate Educator Training was conducted at Siachen Public School
- Teachers explored the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), with special focus on SDG 13: Climate Action, SDG 15: Life on Land, , and SDG 4: Quality Education
- Sessions covered climate justice and multi-species justice, discussing what these concepts mean and why they are important for mountain and rural communities
- Participants reflected on ancestors’ ways of living, traditional knowledge, local language, and how indigenous practices were more climate-friendly and sustainable
- The training emphasized contextual and interactive methods to explain climate change to children in age-appropriate ways
- Teachers discussed and practiced how to teach climate concepts to students, linking classroom learning with local realities and everyday observations
- The School Safety Framework was explored, focusing on disaster preparedness, safe school

Date	Location	Participants	Activity / Session	Key Highlights / Outcomes
				environments, and the role of teachers during emergencies - Teachers recognized schools as key spaces for building climate awareness, resilience, and preparedness among children
4 Dec 2025	Goma & Mashabrum	Local women, AC Mashabrum	Community & official meetings	- Visited women in villages to discuss water scarcity and education needs - Met AC Mashabrum regarding NOC; shared community-based disaster preparedness plans; advised sending proposal to DDMA - Plan to expand SSN with more women, especially older women
6 Dec 2025	Siachen public shool	Female teachers	MHM (Menstrual Hygiene Management) session	- Discussed menstruation, hygiene, PCOS, myths - Shared experiences of students lacking menstrual supplies - Teachers appointed as MHM leaders to spread awareness

Date	Location	Participants	Activity / Session	Key Highlights / Outcomes
6 Dec 2025	Goma	Team RESTRUNG	Team formation	- Team Lead: Sakina Bano - Management Head: Irfan Hassan - Coordinator to MH: Najaf Ali - Social Media Head: M. Naeem - Coordinator to SMH: Haider Ali - Ideas Generator: M. Iraq - Organizers: Tehreem Zahra & Surya - Plan to conduct 3-day capacity building for climate & disaster response
7 Dec 2025	Haji Ali Foo House, Goma	45 women (KOH-E-ZAN, SSN, volunteers)	Women meet-up & MHM session	- Formal meet-up of KOH-E-ZAN - MHM leaders formed (45 leaders, each to train 5 more women/girls) - Prepared go-bags for emergencies - Presented Saheli First Responder Model - Discussed climate change, stockpiling essentials, and availability of birth/baby/hygiene kits - Team networking and collaboration strengthened

Date	Location	Participants	Activity / Session	Key Highlights / Outcomes
9 Dec 2025	Goma & High School	Women & students	Meetings & discussions	- One-on-one with 15 women regarding group formation - Conducted discussions linking religious beliefs and climate change awareness with students and teachers
13 Dec 2025	Siachen Public School, Saltoro	Community & disaster management team	Disaster preparedness session	- Used school results event to gather audience - Discussed disaster preparedness, mental readiness, and rescue tips - Student speech highlighted climate change and community response - Invited rescue team for first aid & training in Goma
15 Dec 2025	Goma	11 women (CBRDMC)	Formation of women's group	- Strategy meeting post-Eid - Discussed climate change & river cut impacts - Reflections led to formation of a women's preparedness group for disaster response

Date	Location	Participants	Activity / Session	Key Highlights / Outcomes
16 Dec 2025	Goma Masjid	Women & girls	Climate awareness session	- Conducted awareness on climate and CBRDMC involvement - Invited interested participants to join the team - Discussed women's collective saving for emergency needs (~PKR 44,000 pooled)
11–13 Dec 2025	Saheli Circle, Goma	Volunteers & mentors	3-day capacity building	- Topics: climate change, risk mapping, safe zones, CBRDMC importance - Developed two action plans: 1) Cleanliness drive & dustbin installation; 2) Awareness & CBRDMC formation
19 Dec 2025	Goma	Team RESTRUNG & community	Cleanliness drive & dustbin installation	- Organized by KOH-E-ZAN under Samina Batool - Active participation of men, women, and children - Raised awareness on cleanliness, community responsibility, and teamwork

Date	Location	Participants	Activity / Session	Key Highlights / Outcomes
21 Dec 2025	Saheli Circle	Saheli girls	Post-exam Saheli circle	- Girls returned to Saheli circle; new members joined - Formed new group and scheduled life skills sessions
23 Dec 2025	Saheli Circle, Goma	Girls & mentor Hina	First climate consciousness session	- Introduced climate education and importance of climate observation - Differentiated between weather and climate; formed 3 groups to observe and record daily weather - Discussed climate change & global warming - Created session timetable for ongoing observation

3. Community Resilience Actions (FLARES in Practice)

What concrete preparedness or response actions were started or strengthened?

Tick and explain:

Tick and Explain Table – Final Complete Version

Activity	Tick	Explanation & Participants
Go-bag awareness sessions conducted	☒	Go-bag awareness sessions were conducted in Saheli Circles with girls. Sessions included teaching what items to pack for emergencies (water, snacks, warm clothes, medicines, important documents). Girls prepared their first go-bags after the sessions. Participants included 18–25 girls per circle.
MHM preparedness discussed for emergencies	☒	Menstrual Health Management (MHM) was discussed with girls and women, including how to manage periods during disasters. Mothers were engaged and guided to seek medical attention if needed. Participants included Saheli Circle facilitators, women’s groups, and mothers.
Community stockpile discussed or started	☒	Stockpiling of essential items was discussed with the CBDRMC and the broader community. Plans were made to mobilize a community fund. Elders, women, youth, and notable community members participated.

Activity	Tick Explanation & Participants
School WASH/bathroom issues raised	WASH issues were raised with school management and the Education Department. During October–November, SMC members discussed functional bathrooms for girls when Education Department representatives visited. ☒ High school girls’ bathrooms were addressed, and other schools also have functional WASH facilities. Water shortages occur during winter as the area freezes. Participants: SMC members, teachers, Education Department staff, and Saheli Circle facilitators.
Early warning or check-in system discussed	While no formal early warning system exists, check-ins occur during disasters or emergencies. Mosque loudspeakers are used effectively, and community members conduct mouth-to-mouth communication by visiting neighbors’ homes. ☒ Women’s groups were trained to actively check on community members’ safety during emergencies. Participants: women’s groups, youth, elders, and community members.
Saheli Circle used as a space for Climate Awareness workshops with girls and women	☒ Saheli Circles were used for climate awareness workshops, completing lessons on climate education, environmental risks, and disaster preparedness. Participants included girls and women from the community.

Activity	Tick	Explanation & Participants
Community Resilience Toolkit crafted	☐	A formal toolkit has not yet been finalized. Lessons from workshops, risk mapping, and discussions are being compiled for future development.
Coordination with local leaders/institutions	☒	Coordination occurred with local leaders, elders, Pakistan Army representatives, and district administration. Specifically, discussions were held with the Assistant Commissioner Ghanche in his office. He showed interest in our initiatives; however, our area is still not officially listed as a “red zone.” Participants: Assistant Commissioner, local elders, community members, and project facilitators.
Community-Based Disaster Risk Management Committee Formed	☒	The CBDRMC was officially formed, including elders, women, girls, youth, and notable community members, ensuring broad representation.
CBDRMC Plans Drafted	☒	Risk mapping and initial plans were drafted. The committee identified safe zones, potential risks, and priority actions for community resilience.
CBDRMC Plans shared with local DDMA's	☐	Plans are ready to be shared with District Disaster Management Authorities (DDMA's), but formal submission is pending after committee approval.

Activity	Tick Explanation & Participants
First-Aid Training Conducted for Women & Girls and/or CBDRMC groups	☒ Youth previously trained in basic first aid through Army-led winter sessions received advanced training in rescue operations and emergency preparedness. Women and CBDRMC members also participated. Additional sessions are planned for both First Aid and Go-Back preparedness.
Life Skills Sessions Conducted	☒ Ongoing life skills sessions continue for children. Sessions are repeated for children whose participation or skill development is most needed, focusing on personal development, confidence, and essential life skills. Participants: girls and boys in Saheli Circles and other targeted groups.
Go-Back Sessions Conducted	☒ Go-Back sessions were conducted with women and girls in Saheli Circles. The sessions included MHM preparedness and detailed disaster Go-Back planning. Women were instructed to follow these practices and to share the information with their households and at least five other community members, helping spread awareness. Workshops focused on resilience, coping strategies, and individual guidance. Participants included women's groups, Saheli Circle facilitators, and girls from the community. Additional Go-Back and First Aid sessions are planned.

4. Organizing & Leadership Work

a) Leadership Team

- How did your leadership team contribute to the work so far?

As our leadership team resides within the community, all members are deeply familiar with the local context, recurring disaster situations, and everyday challenges faced by the population. Their lived experience of floods, harsh winters, difficult terrain, and limited access to services has enabled the team to respond with sensitivity, relevance, and urgency. This strong contextual understanding has been critical in shaping activities that are practical, culturally appropriate, and community-owned.

The leadership team—particularly the Salto Saheli Network—has remained actively engaged throughout the implementation process. Members consistently attended all sessions and played a key role in community organization and mobilization, engaging families, neighbors, and wider village groups. Information and learning from sessions were shared informally at the household and community levels, helping to expand awareness beyond direct participants.

The Saheli mentors, who work closely with adolescent girls, demonstrated a high level of commitment and responsibility. Despite limited resources, they facilitated discussions, supported learning, and ensured safe and inclusive participation for girls. The intentional inclusion of boys and young men within the leadership structure further strengthened the initiative by promoting shared responsibility and collective action. These members actively supported outreach efforts, helped organize community members, and contributed to awareness-raising activities, particularly among male community members.

Overall, the leadership team's strong community roots, combined with their awareness of disaster risks and social vulnerabilities, enabled effective coordination, trust building, and collective ownership of the initiative. This local leadership has been central to advancing disaster preparedness, gender-responsive awareness, and community resilience.

Did anyone take new responsibility?

Yes, several team members and local stakeholders assumed new and complementary responsibilities to support the effective implementation of activities.

- Fatima Kubra took responsibility for organizing and managing refreshments during each session, ensuring smooth logistics and participant comfort.
- Irfan Hassan managed heating arrangements to maintain a safe and conducive learning environment during winter sessions.
- Sakina led communication and coordination with team members and community stakeholders, supporting timely information sharing and participation.
- Mazhar Hussain assumed a key facilitation and outreach role by providing continuous guidance to the team. He actively engaged with his teacher colleagues and other community members to explain the objectives of the initiative, organize meetings, mobilize participation, and build broader understanding and support for the work at the community level.

In addition, Lady Health Visitors (LHVs) and two Lady Health Workers (LHWs) closely collaborated with the team during Menstrual Hygiene Management (MHM) and Go-Bag preparedness sessions. Their professional roles align closely with the project objectives, enabling strong coordination on MHM, Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR), and awareness raising around Go-Bag preparedness for disaster situations as well as for routine and emergency travel needs.

Special emphasis was placed on preparedness for pregnancy, delivery, and medical emergencies, as women in the community often need to travel to nearby cities due to limited local health facilities. This collaboration strengthened community trust, ensured technical accuracy of health information, and enhanced the overall reach and sustainability of the intervention

B) Wider Community Involvement

Who else became involved (parents, teachers, health workers, local elders, youth)?

The initiative engaged a wide range of community members to ensure strong support and collaboration. This included parents, who encouraged girls' participation and supported Saheli activities; teachers and school administrators, who provided space, guidance, and mentorship; Lady Health Visitors (LHVs) and Lady Health Workers (LHWs), who contributed expertise during MHM and Go-Bag preparedness sessions; local elders, who advised on culturally appropriate approaches and helped legitimize activities; and youth volunteers, both boys and girls, who assisted in awareness campaigns, climate gatherings, and community resilience initiatives.

- Any resistance or support from the community?

Overall, the community was supportive, particularly after seeing the value of awareness sessions, preparedness training, and women-led initiatives. Some initial resistance arose around the inclusive youth groups with boys and girls, as well as concerns about girls' participation outside the home. These concerns were addressed through dialogue, trust-building, and involving women's group members as community communicators. Over time, resistance decreased, and participation and support grew across the community.

c) Decision-Making

- What decisions did you and your team make together?

The team collectively made several key decisions to ensure the initiative was inclusive, coordinated, and values-driven. One of the earliest decisions, led by the Salto Saheli Network, was the inclusion of boys and young men in the program to promote shared responsibility and strengthen community acceptance.

During a dedicated team meeting, the leadership also jointly defined the team ethos, agreeing on principles such as mutual respect, shared responsibility, transparency, gender sensitivity, and community accountability. This agreed ethos has guided the team's behavior, decision-making, and engagement with community members throughout implementation.

The team further decided to divide roles and responsibilities based on individual capacity and availability to ensure smooth coordination. Session days and schedules were finalized collectively, keeping in view weather conditions, accessibility, and community routines.

Decisions related to the training of climate education program mentors were made after assessing mentor availability and seasonal weather challenges. In addition, the team collaboratively developed a resilience planning approach and jointly worked on outlining a community resilience plan, focusing on disaster preparedness and long-term community resilience.

Several activities and actions have also been planned for future phases, reflecting the team's ongoing commitment to collective planning, adaptability, and sustained engagement.

- What was difficult to decide?

During the course of our work, there were no major difficulties in implementing activities. However, deciding on the timing of certain community gatherings was slightly challenging due to weather conditions. We needed to ensure sessions were held when it was safe and accessible for participants, especially during harsh or unpredictable weather.

Additionally, using social media as a tool for outreach posed some challenges. Due to various constraints, we were unable to fully utilize social media for communication and awareness-raising as initially planned. Despite this, the team adapted by relying on direct community engagement and face-to-face interactions to maintain participation and information sharing.

5. Gender, Climate, MHM & WASH Insights

What did you learn about how climate issues affect girls and women in your area?

Climate issues in our area have a disproportionate impact on girls and women, and their challenges are often compounded during and after disasters. I personally witnessed this during a recent flood, when the local bridge was washed away, leaving many families completely isolated. While men were often able to navigate mountainous paths to reach markets, community centers, or connect with others, women remained confined to their homes, unable to access essential services or socialize.

For girls, particularly school-going girls, these conditions make it difficult to attend school on time or at all. Long distances, disrupted transport, and additional household responsibilities sometimes cause girls to skip school or arrive late, impacting their education. Women's existing household responsibilities—such as cooking, childcare, and caring for sick children—continue even during disasters, adding mental and physical stress.

Access to clean water is another major challenge during disasters. Water systems are often disrupted, forcing women to travel long distances to fetch water, increasing the risk of fatigue, urinary tract infections (UTIs), and other health issues. Hygiene challenges, combined with limited menstrual health resources, also affect physical and mental health, especially when women have to reuse sanitary materials due to scarcity.

Post-disaster winters add another layer of difficulty. Women continue to manage essential household tasks despite harsh cold and snowfall—they must fetch water, care for livestock such as cows and goats, look after children, and manage the household, without being able to take breaks from their responsibilities. This continuous workload, under extreme weather conditions, intensifies both their physical and mental burdens.

Overall, climate-related disruptions multiply the responsibilities and vulnerabilities of women and girls, impacting their health, education, mobility, and overall well-being. These observations highlight the urgent need for gender-sensitive disaster preparedness, MHM support, and community resilience planning in our area.

a6. Data & Observations (Gender-Responsive)

If possible, share estimates:

- %-age of community awareness (before your work) about climate change and its connection with yearly disasters like floods, rains.

The community is aware of disasters as they experience them in their lives but about climate change and global warming less than 10 % of the community was aware and these are those who are mostly educated. Other people thought these are due to GOD will.

- What are some of the most common myths in your community connected to natural disasters?

some of the common myths we gathered from our community are:

1. Disasters caused by divine wrath or devils
 - Many community members believe that natural disasters are caused by supernatural forces, such as devils or divine punishment for sins.
2. Animals killed cruelly cause disasters
 - Some people think that if an animal like dog, lizard is killed cruelly, it brings misfortune or triggers natural disasters such as floods or storms.
3. Women wearing red clothes near rivers cause floods
 - There is a belief that if a woman wears red clothing near a river, the water level will rise or floods will occur also during disasters women are prohibited to come to the disaster area.
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4. Glaciers have male and female characteristics
 - Community myths say that glaciers are male or female. A yellow glacier is calm and travels slowly, posing little danger. A red glacier is dangerous and can move toward human settlements, causing disasters.
5. Disasters predicted by animal behavior or omens
 - Some believe that unusual animal behavior (like cows lying down or dogs barking excessively) signals an imminent disaster.
6. Rituals or prayers can prevent disasters
 - Many perform specific rituals such as Quran khwani or prayers to stop floods, snowstorms, or avalanches.
7. If a disaster hasn't occurred for a long time, it won't happen
 - Some assume that areas with no recent floods, landslides, or snowstorms are safe indefinitely.

8. If a community or household don't offer prayers are men not come to mosque increase sins and which will collectively cause disasters.

- What are some of the care ethics you learned about in your discussions with community elders?

While interacting with community elders, we were always careful not to deny or dismiss their beliefs. We respected that their thoughts and understandings were part of their personal and cultural worldview. At no point did we tell them that they were wrong, nor did we attempt to “teach them science” in a way that would contradict their spiritual or traditional perspectives.

From our observations, the community has a deep connection with nature and interprets events through natural and spiritual lenses. Their strongest belief is in Allah, and this spiritual understanding guides much of their worldview.

During discussions, we built on their perspectives rather than challenging them directly. For example, when talking about floods, we used real-life examples, including recent floods in our area and other regions, to help them understand possible outcomes. However, we always framed these examples in a way that respected their beliefs, using their own concepts and language as the starting point.

This approach ensured that the dialogue remained respectful, culturally sensitive, and effective, while also gently introducing practical insights.

- How many female climate leaders have you enabled/engaged?

We had engaged nearly all female in our village in different gatherings ,and sessions but we had 10 elder women in our women group that are aware of climate change and they can narrate climate change in their own words , also 8 young girls in saltoro Saheli network ,our Saheli circle girls(18 girls in Goma , 22 in Saheli circle saith ,and girls of khani village) are our climate leader at this time because they are being educated on Saheli climate consciousness and our mentors from different villages of saltoro are enabled and engaged at this moment.

- How many MHM Leaders have you enabled? In how many villages/schools?

We organized a day-long workshop for all members of our Leadership Team (LT) and representatives of KOH-E-ZAN, focused on Menstrual Health Management (MHM) and Go Bag preparedness. A total of 45 women attended the workshop. Each participant was assigned to enable at least 5 women in their circle or conduct a session in their respective village.

After the floods, we conducted several sessions in Goma and other Saheli circles across saltoro. In Goma and the Malon Saheli circle, we distributed MHM kits, guided participants women and girls on proper usage, and assisted with their safe disposal. Also had a session with 6 female teachers at Siachen public school.

In total, we reached 350 women and girls, distributed as follows:

- 45 women in the workshop
- 150 women and girls in Goma
- 32 girls in Saheli Circle Saith
- 21 girls in Khani village
- 15 girls in Malon village
- 11 girls in Manik village
- 70 girls in High School Saith, Saltoro
- 6 female teachers in Siachen public school

Through these efforts, our trained MHM leaders have enabled a wide network of women and girls across multiple villages and schools, promoting awareness, hygiene, and preparedness in the community.

- How many people have you organized through your campaign?
800 peoples
- How many girls and women have you engaged/built the capacity of?
150+
6
- # of climate gatherings conducted with girls through Saheli Circle
Till now we had conducted 10-15 climate gatherings in each Saheli circle and many of them are schedule up to 28 February.
- # of gatherings with girls/outcomes
- # of gatherings with women/outcomes

We initially had one on with them and had 3 gatherings with women which result in the formation of our women group also increased their climate knowledge, also we learned from them about their thoughts. Further some gatherings are in process which will be on First aid and CBDRM meetings.

- # of gatherings with community/outcomes
- # of gatherings with youth/outcomes

We had 3 days of capacity building training with our volunteer youth and 4 meetings total 7 gatherings till now, we had worked together on boosting our climate knowledge , understanding our geography by risk mapping and resilience planning also we had conducted a dustbin installation and cleanliness drive in our village to do an on ground work.

- # of women enabled with go-back preparedness?
60 women till now but the work is still ongoing they are planned with rescue trainings.
- # of women enabled with emotional calmness strategies?
120+ In our every session we do exercises which comprises of mental and emotional calmness.

How many women are part of the women's group for climate justice in my community? What role do they have?

There are 10 women who are currently part of the women's group for climate justice in the community. At present, these women are in the capacity-building phase. Their primary role will be community organizing and coordination.

Before and during disasters, they will function as local communication channels, helping to share timely information, connect households with support systems, and coordinate community responses. The aim is to ensure that women are not only victims of climate impacts, but instead play an active, informed, and leadership-driven role in preparedness, response, and recovery efforts.

- How many people are part of my CBDRMC? What roles do they have?
There are 15 members in CBDRMC, the primary role of the committee is disasters preparedness and advocacy but till now roles are not properly assigned.
- Was an agreement reached for a community stockpiling fund and supply storage for disaster preparedness?

Not now with CBDRMC but we had included stockpiling in our resilience plan and is planned to discussed in the CBDRM Meeting

- What is the status of the production of *My Valley's Climate Knowledge Guide*?

We had gathered data from community, and data are in digitalization process

7. Challenges Faced

What made your work difficult?

There were no major difficulties in implementing the work. we were well trained, and because we already have strong real-life experience working in the community, most processes went smoothly and as planned.

Some challenges did arise, mainly related to weather conditions, travel limitations, and financial expenses, especially during winter. However, these were manageable, and the team handled them effectively through planning, flexine challenge was community resistance to forming an inclusive youth group involving both boys and girls. Some community members expressed concerns and objections about mixed participation, especially in joint sitting and activities. This hesitation was rooted in social norms and misunderstandings about the purpose of the initiative. ability, and mutual support.

8. How Did You Respond to Challenges?

What strategies did you use?

- To address this, we engaged community members specially our women group in open and respectful dialogue, explained the objectives, safeguards, and benefits of inclusive youth participation, and gradually built trust took them into confidence, and enabled them to act as community communicators, helping convey the purpose and values of the initiative to others.
- Additionally, we worked through teachers and Saheli Circles, adjusted activity formats when needed, and remained flexible in planning. These strategies helped reduce resistance, strengthen acceptance, and ensure smooth continuation of activities.
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9. Personal Leadership Reflection

Answer honestly:

- What has your work so far taught you about leadership?

When we studied leadership, we explored that the term “leader” is a construct. A leader is often expected to be perfect, but no one is perfect in this world. Through my field experience, I realized that leadership is not about being flawless or doing everything alone. One person cannot manage everything, but at the same time, not everyone can do everything either. Leadership requires balance. As an organizer, I learned that if someone genuinely wants to create change, they must be ready to take responsibility. This includes carrying some level of burden—organizational, emotional, and practical. Leadership is not about authority or control; it is about taking initiative, guiding others, encouraging participation, and motivating people to move forward together. Leadership is simply about taking the lead and giving courage and direction to others.

- When did you feel strong as an organizer?

I often felt strong as an organizer when I saw my ideas turning into action. When the work we planned started happening on the ground, or when I noticed signs that community members were beginning to think in the same direction, it gave me confidence. Seeing people reflect the same concerns, thoughts, or solutions that we had discussed made me feel that the work was meaningful and effective.

This time, we faced very little judgment because the youth were also with us and actively participating. There was no one questioning, “*Why are you going? What are you doing? How are you doing it?*” Their presence created a sense of solidarity and support. Knowing that they were alongside us made both the team and the community members feel encouraged and confident. This collective participation strengthened our work and made the process smoother and more effective.

Feeling that others were gradually aligning with the vision I carried showed me that change was possible and that collective thinking was being built within the community.

- When did you feel unsure or tired?

Honestly ,I did not feel tired in this work. The work was very close to our lived realities and deeply connected to real-life experiences. It was something new that we were emerging and building from the ground up. Because it was practical, visible, and meaningful, it never felt exhausting or overwhelming.

The people working alongside us also never felt that we were discussing unrealistic or imaginary ideas. They related to the issues directly, as these were part of their own daily lives, which created trust and sustained energy.

- How did you take care of yourself?

We took conscious care of ourselves throughout the process and regularly practiced self-care. Since the work never felt like a burden and we clearly understood what we were doing, it did not create stress or burnout. Our strong understanding of the work and its relevance to our lives helped us stay emotionally balanced, motivated, and confident.

This clarity and connection to purpose allowed us to continue our work with energy and commitment, without feeling overwhelmed.

10. Stories from the Field

Share at least one short story that shows impact.

Example:

A girl who prepared her first go-bag

Najma, my sister-in-law, attended the session and, afterward, prepared a bag for her daughter at home. She packed it with various essential items, including a

blanket, warm clothes, a feeder, and other personal necessities. Najma prepared this bag with the intention that it would be ready in case of any emergency or situation where it might be needed.

Additionally, in the Saheli Circle, when we introduced this concept, we placed a bag with the children and guided them to take turns practicing how to pack it properly. We also gave them a task to do at home: to pack their own bags and develop this as a habit, so that they are prepared not only for disasters but also for any regular day when they might need it.

- A mother who changed her thinking about MHM

Kulsoom, a mother of two girls from our village, attended one of our Saheli Circle sessions. During the session, she shared a concern about her younger daughter, who experiences severe pain during her periods. For the first two days of menstruation, her daughter is unable to eat or even get out of bed. Until now, Kulsoom had not taken her daughter to any doctor, believing that the pain might subside after marriage because her daughter is still very young. We advised her that while it is common for girls to experience some pain during periods, excessive pain should be checked by a healthcare professional to prevent future complications. Initially, she was hesitant and worried about getting her daughter checked. However, after our discussion, she took our advice seriously. Later, Kulsoom informed us that she had taken her daughter to a gynecologist in Khaplu for a proper checkup. She expressed gratitude for the session, saying that it helped her understand the importance of addressing menstrual health issues early rather than waiting.

- A climate-related event/gathering in the community
Till now we had not arranged a bigger event but we will conduct it soon, but we used the schools results days as a platform where we can talk about climate , we prepared speeches by students and highlighted the issue to whole community ,with this Rescue 1122 also conducted a session in Siachen public school with as on disasters and fire safety with community.
- A moment of community solidarity
- Our community has a strong sense of solidarity. People share each other's joys and sorrows, participate in events together, and support one another

during disasters. The community also has a fund to carry out welfare activities.

A clear example of this was when Pakistan Army representatives visited our Saheli Circle. While their main purpose was to provide internet access, we shared our community resilience plans with them, including stockpiling and preparedness measures. The Army appreciated our plans and offered support, recognizing that in this remote area they often respond before the local administration. All community members participated, showing that disaster preparedness is a shared responsibility. This event highlighted the power of collective action and community solidarity.

- **CBDMRMC Formation**

The Community-Based Disaster Risk Management Committee (CBDMRC) has been officially formed. The committee includes elders, women, girls, youth, and notable members of the community, ensuring broad representation and participation.

The first phase of the committee's work, including risk mapping, has been successfully completed. The entire community is now aware of potential risks and the locations of safe zones.

The next step is to make a collective decision through a committee meeting to:

1. Develop a set of community demands or priorities.
2. Mobilize a community fund to support disaster preparedness activities. The community has a strong culture of contributing to such funds, and recently they successfully generated a significant fund. Organizing and motivating the community around this will be our responsibility.
3. Plan for upcoming challenges next year, such as blocked water channels. The committee will discuss and propose solutions to address these issues.

Next Steps / Goals:

- Hold a committee meeting to reach consensus on priorities.
- Mobilize the community fund to support resilience and disaster preparedness initiatives.

- To reach stakeholders such as , DDMA and District Administration and Pak Army.

11. Support Needed from IEI

What do you need to do your work better?

IEI has provided excellent support throughout the project. However, as the project approaches its closure, we want to ensure that our work continues and that the momentum we have built in the community is not lost. Since our team is embedded within the community, we plan to continue our activities independently, but for the next disaster season, God forbid any emergency arises, we would like to continue our work—particularly in areas like stockpiling and mental health support.

Currently, our Saheli Circles are active, and we do not want to discontinue them. Continued support from IEI—through guidance, resources, and assistance—will help sustain these groups and ensure they remain active.. It would be especially helpful if there are online sessions, classes, or trainings on mental health that we and our team could participate in.

Receiving necessary materials for mental health sessions and emergency preparedness before the disaster season begins would allow us to implement activities immediately without delay. Overall, continued support will ensure that both disaster preparedness initiatives and Saheli Circles remain active and effective in empowering our community.

12. Plans for the Remaining Grant

What are your next plans?

With the remaining grant funds, we aim to complete ongoing initiatives and strengthen community preparedness, education, and resilience. Our plan includes the following key activities:

1. Complete Saheli climate consciousness lessons in Saheli Circles
 - Finish all pending climate education courses in Saheli circles.
2. CDRMC Documentation and Reporting
 - A joint meeting of committee assigning roles and responsibilities
 - Document the activities of the Community Disaster Risk Management Committee (CDRMC) and its sub-committees.
 - Share this documentation with the District Administration and District Management Authority (DMMA) to strengthen formal recognition and collaboration.
3. Strengthen Women's Groups
 - Empower women to actively participate, voice their opinions, and engage in community decision-making.
4. Youth First Aid and Advanced Rescue Training
 - Provide advanced first aid and emergency response training to youth who already have basic first aid skills.
 - Include rescue operations and emergency preparedness modules.
 - Conduct Go bag sessions with community
5. Stockpiling and Community Fund Mobilization
 - Mobilize a community fund to procure emergency supplies.
 - Ensure sufficient stockpiling ahead of the winter disaster season.
6. Winter Camp Emergency Education
 - Integrate emergency preparedness sessions into winter camp activities:
 - Go bags preparation in disaster and also normal situations,

- MHM session with girls

7. Ongoing Life Skills Sessions

- Continue life skills sessions for children who had started earlier in Heldi mandik and khani villages.

13. Financial Breakdowns

Add all project expense breakdowns in a tabular format below.

01	Stationary for trainings and Saheli circles	10480
02	Transport for volunteer (2-days capacity building)	4000
03	refreshment	3000
04	Acrylic paints 6 piece 350 each	2100
05	Brush set +5 canvas	380+600=980
06	MHM and Go Bag workshop Refreshment	8000
07	Transport	2000
08	Milk pack+ Heating K2 +Easy load +steel pins	2280
09	Team meetings refreshments	5000
10	Visit to Maheli circle saith and Mandik	1500
11	Visit to sahelu circle heldi	1000
12	1 Can K2 (Heating oil)	4000
13	Stationary for sahelu circle Heldi	3500
14	2 bottle of Color yellow and green 1 kg+500g	2000
15	Siachen public school 4 days refreshment+1 day transport	3500
16	2 litter k2	370
	Total	54070